

# Cybersecurity for SME Employees

## Module 4.2 – Data Handling Do's and Don'ts

### 1 Objective

Equip employees with clear and practical guidance on the correct ways to handle sensitive data at work—minimizing risks through smart behavior.

### 2 Introduction

Handling sensitive data isn't just a technical issue—it's a behavioral one. How you access, use, share, and store data can make or break your company's cybersecurity posture. This module provides actionable do's and don'ts for everyday data handling.

### 3 Access Control

#### Do:

- Access only the data you need to do your job.
- Use company-approved systems to access data.
- Log out when stepping away from your device.

#### Don't:

- Share login credentials with anyone—even coworkers.
- Use someone else's account to access files.
- Leave sensitive documents unattended or unlocked.

### 4 Data Sharing

#### Do:

- Use secure file-sharing platforms approved by IT.
- Double-check recipient email addresses before sending.
- Encrypt sensitive files if sending externally.

**Don't:**

- Send sensitive information via WhatsApp or personal email.
- Upload business data to public drives or folders.
- Share sensitive data over unsecured networks.

## **5 Data Storage**

**Do:**

- Store files only on company-approved devices and drives.
- Use encrypted storage for confidential information.
- Regularly back up important data as per company policy.

**Don't:**

- Save sensitive files on personal USB drives.
- Leave printed documents in common areas.
- Ignore software or system update reminders.

## **6 Minimal Privilege Principle**

- Only provide access to those who genuinely need it.
- Revoke access for users who change roles or leave.
- Use “view only” permissions when full access isn't necessary.

## **7 Document Retention**

- Follow the company's data retention policy.
- Dispose of old documents securely—shred paper or wipe drives.
- Archive old data only in secure, approved systems.

## **8 Red Flags to Watch For**

- Requests for access from unknown users.
- Colleagues bypassing official data-sharing processes.
- Devices behaving strangely after handling files.

## 9 Conclusion

Handling data responsibly isn't optional—it's essential. A small mistake can lead to big problems, but consistent, secure behavior can protect your company and your customers. In the next module, we'll explore how to interpret and apply your organization's privacy policies.